

Definitions

Aboriginal	Includes First Nations, Inuit, and Metis. An aboriginal child is defined as having at least one parent who is Aboriginal.
Airborne Precautions	Includes specific recommendations for personal protective equipment (including N95 masks), good hand hygiene practice, patient accommodation (private negative pressure room), and transport.
Airborne Transmission	Occurs by the dissemination of droplet nuclei, less than 5 microns in diameter, containing microorganisms dispersed by air currents, that may subsequently be inhaled by people.
Congenital Infection	An infection transmitted from an infected mother to her unborn infant resulting in birth defects or abnormalities in the newborn.
Contact Precautions	Infection prevention and control measures that reduce contact (direct and indirect) with microorganisms such as hand washing, barriers (e.g., gloves) and single room patient accommodation would be used.
Contact Transmission	Includes direct contact, indirect contact and droplet (large droplet) transmission as described below. Although droplet transmission is a type of contact transmission, it is considered separately as it requires different precautions. • Direct contact occurs when the transfer of micro-organisms results from direct physical contact between an infected or colonized individual and a susceptible host (body surface to body surface). • Indirect contact involves the passive transfer of micro-organisms to a susceptible host via an intermediate object such as contaminated hands that are not washed between patients, contaminated instruments or other inanimate objects.
Direct fluorescent antibody	DFA is a test that uses fluorescent antibody to directly detect an antigen. In microbiology, DFA is used to detect the presence of microorganism antigens in body fluids by using antibodies tagged with a fluorescent dye. A common use for this test is to screen for respiratory viruses i.e., influenza, para-influenza, RSV from respiratory samples such as nasopharyngeal (NP) swabs.

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Droplet Precautions	Occurs by the dissemination of microorganisms contained in droplets of respiratory secretions, 5 microns or larger in diameter, for distances of one metre through the air with subsequent exposure to people. Coughing and sneezing, even talking and laughing, are associated with expulsion of a large number of droplets of varying size.
Droplet Transmission	The use of surgical masks, eye protection, or face shields when caring for patients with acute febrile respiratory infection, particularly when within one metre of a patient that is coughing or sneezing and during procedures that generate splashes or sprays of body fluids or secretions (e.g., suctioning).
Endemic	A disease/infection/condition that is continuously prevalent in some degree in a community or region.
Enzyme Linked Immunosorbent Assay or Enzyme Immunoassay	ELISA or EIA for short is a sensitive technique for accurately determining specific molecules in a mixed sample. The amount of protein such as an antibody or other antigen in a given sample is determined by means of an enzyme-catalysed colour change. Commonly screened for blood-borne pathogens such as HIV, hepatitis B and C are screened for using EIA technology.
Epidemic	The occurrence in a community or region of cases of an illness (or an outbreak) with a frequency clearly in excess of normal expectancy
IgA	This antibody plays an important role in the body's defenses against the invasion of microorganisms through mucous membrane-lined surfaces, including the nose, eyes, lungs, and intestines. IgA is found in the blood and in secretions such as those in the GI tract and in the nose, eyes, lung, and breast milk.
IgG	The most prevalent type of antibody, it is produced upon subsequent exposure to an antigen. The secondary antibody response is faster and more abundant than the primary antibody response. IgG is present in both the blood and the tissue. It is the only antibody that is transferred across the placenta from the mother to fetus. The mother's IgG protects the fetus and newborn until the infant's immune system can produce its own antibodies.
IgM	This antibody that is produced upon initial exposure to an antigen. IgM is abundant in the blood but is not normally present in organs or tissues.

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Immune Globulin (IG)	A sterile preparation of concentrated antibodies (immune globulins) recovered from pooled human plasma processed by bold ethanol fractionation. Only plasm that has tested negative for a) hepatitis B surface antigen (HBsAg), b) antibody to human immunodeficiency virus (HIV), and c) antibody to hepatitis C virus (HCV) is used to manufacture IG. IG is administered to protect against certain diseases through passive transfer of antibody.
Incidence	The number of new cases of a given disease over a given period of time.
MSM	Men who have had sex with men; this includes men who report either homosexual or bisexual contact.
Neonate	An infant in the first month of life.
Perinatal Transmission	The transmission of disease from an infected mother to her child either in utero, during childbirth, or through breastfeeding.
Polymerase Chain Reaction	PCR is a highly sensitive test that can detect small amounts of DNA or RNA (genetic material) in a blood or tissue sample using an amplification technique that multiplies the existing DNA/RNA so that it can more easily be detected. Examples of where PCR has revolutionized clinical medicine is for diagnosing disease such as herpes meningitis from CSF, norovirus from stool as well as monitoring viral loads for those infected with HIV, hepatitis B or CMV.
Prodrome	An early symptom suggestive of the onset of an attack or disease.
Routine Practices	Infection prevention and control system including precautions to reduce the risk of transmission of organisms in heathcare. A synonymous term is standard precautions. Routine practices incorporate previous precautions for bloodborne pathogens, i.e., Universal Precautions.
Western Blot	WB aka Immunoblot is a technique which transfers proteins electrophoretically separated in a polyacryliamide gel to a nitrocellulose membrane and uses specific antibodies to bind, locate, and visualize the protein of interest. An example of a WB application is for confirmatory testing of HIV or hepatitis C virus infection (HCV) after positive screening EIA. HIV or HCV proteins are immobilized on a membrane that is them exposed to a patient's serum sample. If the patient is infected with HIV, they will have antibodies that bind to the immobilized HIV or HCV proteins on the membrane.